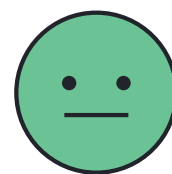
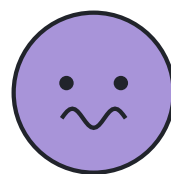
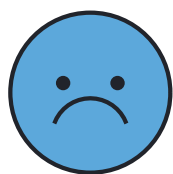


TEEN WELLBEING SEL SERIES



People Skills

Navigating Friendships, Conflict & Boundaries - A Teen Workbook

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

Ages 10-19 - Printable

Home - Classroom - Counseling - Calm Corners

Reproducible for one home or classroom



How to Use This Book

This workbook is made for ages 10 to 19 - a stage packed with change, pressure, and big emotions. It won't talk down to you. Instead, it gives you real tools, honest questions, and space to think for yourself.

There are no grades and no wrong answers. Work at your own pace, be honest in the writing spaces, and come back to the pages that help most. Skills grow with practice.

For Grown-Ups

- ☐ Give privacy - journaling is more honest when it isn't graded or read without permission.
- ☐ Offer to talk, but don't force it; being available matters more than pushing.
- ☐ Model the skills yourself - teens notice what adults actually do.
- ☐ If big feelings feel unmanageable, connect the teen with a counselor or trusted professional.

Tip: There are no wrong answers here. Every feeling is okay. What matters is what we choose to DO with big feelings.



How This Book Works

Each part mixes three things: short explanations of what's going on in your brain and body, self-checks to notice your own patterns, and tools plus reflection to help you respond in ways you feel good about.

Getting the most from it

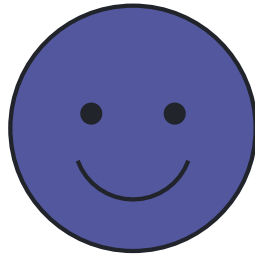
- ☐ Be honest - this is for you, not for show.
- ☐ Try the tools more than once before deciding if they help.
- ☐ Use the trackers to spot patterns over a week or two.
- ☐ Revisit the plans and update them as you learn.

This activity book supports everyday social-emotional learning and self-reflection. It is not therapy or medical advice. If you are struggling with your safety or mental health, please talk to a trusted adult, a counselor, or a local helpline right away.

What's Inside



- 1 Understanding Relationships
- 2 Communication Skills
- 3 Boundaries
- 4 Handling Conflict
- 5 Real-Life Scenarios
- 6 Reflection & Plan



Part 1: Understanding Relationships

Good relationships are built on skills you can learn.



What Makes a Healthy Friendship

Healthy friendships are two-way: respect, honesty, support, and give-and-take go both ways. In healthy friendships you can be yourself, disagree without it ending everything, and count on each other.

Unhealthy or one-sided friendships often leave you drained, anxious, or walking on eggshells. Noticing the difference helps you invest in the right people.

Green flags vs. red flags

- ☐ Green: they respect your 'no' and celebrate your wins.
- ☐ Green: you can be honest without fear.
- ☐ Red: it's always about them, or you feel controlled.
- ☐ Red: they pressure, guilt-trip, or put you down.



How I Show Up With Others

Rate how true each is for you.

1 = Never 5 = Always

I listen without planning my reply.

1 2 3 4 5

I can disagree respectfully.

1 2 3 4 5

I keep others' secrets and trust.

1 2 3 4 5

I can say 'no' when I need to.

1 2 3 4 5

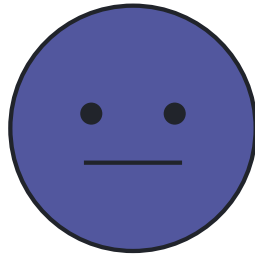
I apologize and repair when I'm wrong.

1 2 3 4 5

I treat others how I want to be treated.

1 2 3 4 5

What my answers tell me



Part 2: Communication Skills

How you say it matters.



Passive, Aggressive, or Assertive?

Passive means burying your needs to keep the peace. Aggressive means pushing your needs at others' expense. Assertive - the sweet spot - means expressing your needs honestly AND respecting others.

Assertive communication uses calm, clear 'I' statements: 'I feel ____ when ____ because ____.' I'd like ____.' It's a skill worth practicing out loud.

The assertive formula

- ☐ Say what you feel, not just what they did wrong.
- ☐ Be specific and calm.
- ☐ Ask clearly for what you'd like.



'I' Statement Practice

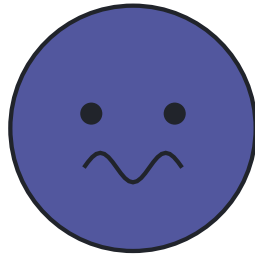
Turn blame into an 'I' statement. Fill in real situations from your life.

I feel ____ when ____ because ____ . I'd like ____ .

I feel ____ when ____ because ____ . I'd like ____ .

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I feel ____ when ____ because ____ . I'd like ____ .



Part 3: Boundaries

Boundaries protect relationships, not end them.



Why Boundaries Are Healthy

A boundary is a limit that keeps you safe and respected. Saying 'no,' asking for space, or not sharing something isn't mean - it's self-respect. People who care about you will respect your boundaries.

You're allowed to have limits, and you don't owe everyone a long explanation. 'No' can be a complete sentence, kindly said.

Boundaries can sound like

- ☐ 'That doesn't work for me.'
- ☐ 'I'm not comfortable with that.'
- ☐ 'I need some time to myself.'



Saying It: Boundary Scripts

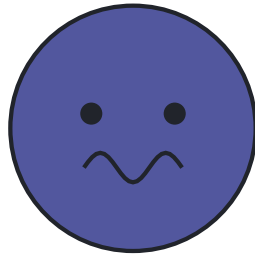
A boundary is a limit that protects your wellbeing. Boundaries can be kind AND firm. Practice wording so it's ready when you need it.

Saying no without over-explaining: "No thanks, that doesn't work for me." My version:

Asking for space: "I need some time to myself right now." My version:

Naming a limit online: "Please don't share that." My version:

Asking for what I need: "It would help me if..." My version:



Part 4: Handling Conflict

Conflict handled well can make bonds stronger.



Reframing Conflict Thoughts

Our thoughts shape our feelings. Sometimes an automatic thought is unhelpful or untrue. You can CATCH the thought, CHECK if it's fair and true, and CHANGE it into a more balanced one. This is a skill - it gets easier with practice.

1. The situation (just the facts):

2. The automatic thought that popped up:

3. The feeling it gave me (and how strong, 0-10):

4. Check it: Is it 100% true? What's the evidence? Am I mind-reading or catastrophizing?

5. A more balanced, fair thought:

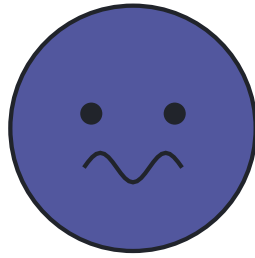
6. How I feel now:



A Conflict I'm Carrying

Describe a conflict that's on your mind. What's your part in it?

What would a fair, respectful next step look like?



Part 5: Real-Life Scenarios

Practice people skills.



Friendship Situations (1)

Read each situation. There are many good choices! Think it through, then write or draw what you could do to stay calm and kind.

- 1 A close friend keeps cancelling and you feel taken for granted.**

What could you do?

- 2 Two friends want you to pick a side in their fight.**

What could you do?

- 3 A friend pressures you to do something you don't want to.**

What could you do?



Friendship Situations (2)

Read each situation. There are many good choices! Think it through, then write or draw what you could do to stay calm and kind.

1 You feel left out of a group you used to belong to.

What could you do?

2 A friendship has become one-sided and draining.

What could you do?

3 You hurt a friend and need to make it right.

What could you do?



My People-Skills Plan

Your plan for healthier relationships.

A boundary I need to set (and with whom):

An 'I' statement I want to practice:

How I'll handle conflict more calmly:

A relationship I want to invest in:

My Personal Wellbeing Plan



Pull it all together. This is your go-to plan when things get hard.

My early warning signs that a feeling is getting big:

My top 3 tools that actually work for me:

People I can reach out to (and how):

Kind, true things I can tell myself:

One habit that helps me feel steady:



When You Need More Help

Some feelings are too big to handle alone - and that's not weakness, it's human. Reaching out is a strong, smart move.

Reach out if...

- ☐ A feeling won't ease up for days, or keeps getting worse.
- ☐ You're avoiding things you used to enjoy.
- ☐ You have thoughts of hurting yourself or others.
- ☐ You just need someone to talk to - that's reason enough.

Who I can reach out to

If you ever feel unsafe or think about hurting yourself, tell a trusted adult now or contact a local emergency number or crisis/helpline in your country right away. You deserve support.



What Matters to Me

Knowing what matters to you makes decisions and hard days easier. When you act in line with your values, stress often makes more sense and feels more manageable.

Three values that matter most to me

One goal that fits those values

One small step I can take this week



Checking In With Myself

What's one thing I'm handling better than I used to?

What still feels hard, and what might help?



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A Letter to Future Me

Write a short letter to yourself six months from now.

What do you hope is different? What do you want to remember?



Good Things Worth Noticing

Noticing good things helps calm our minds and lift our mood. It doesn't erase hard feelings, but it reminds us that good things are here too.

Three good things about today

Someone I'm thankful for - and why

Draw something that makes you smile:



My Notes & Reflections



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A series of horizontal lines for writing notes and reflections.



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